

FOREWORD

If you're reading this book, it is because at some point, you have worried, or are currently worried, about money. Talking about money, even if you have it, is a curious taboo. We rarely have open and honest conversations about our spending and saving habits.

People may boast about great investments, like the stock that made them super-sized returns, but shy away from mentioning the strain on their financial life caused by their expensive spending habits – like that fancy coffee they order twice a day. We worry about investment the way we worry about our weight. Instead of dieting or investing being a habit, we only think of them as remedial measures when our weight or our bank balance goes too high or too low.

This is further exacerbated by the fact that the commission-driven world of finance has been deliberately obfuscated for the layman. Navigating through the jargon can feel like trying to cut through a dense thicket with a butter knife. No wonder then, like the proverbial ostrich, many of us stick our heads in the sand, hoping if we don't see the problem, it doesn't see us too. Which is why I appreciate Monika's new book. It wants us to start having honest conversations about money. This means admitting that our excuses are just that: excuses. Managing your finances is not a luxury for the rich, it is hygiene for everyone.

I know Monika from her role as consulting editor at *Mint*. In our interactions, I was always struck by her focus on the consumer. She would ask all the hard questions about complex economic affairs and then work to communicate them simply to her audience. As you reach [Chapter 6](#) you will learn why.

Monika is not some prodigious financial genius, picking blockbuster investments since she was sixteen. In the true spirit of talking honestly about